Navigating the Intersection of

Career Uncertainty & Gen-Z Wellbeing

Average of Total Graduates	Unemployment Rate (%)	Labor Force Participation Rate (%)	Gen-Z Anxiety Index
5.49M	3.76%	85.42%	30.10

Overview

Labor Mismatch

Mental Health

Job Struggles

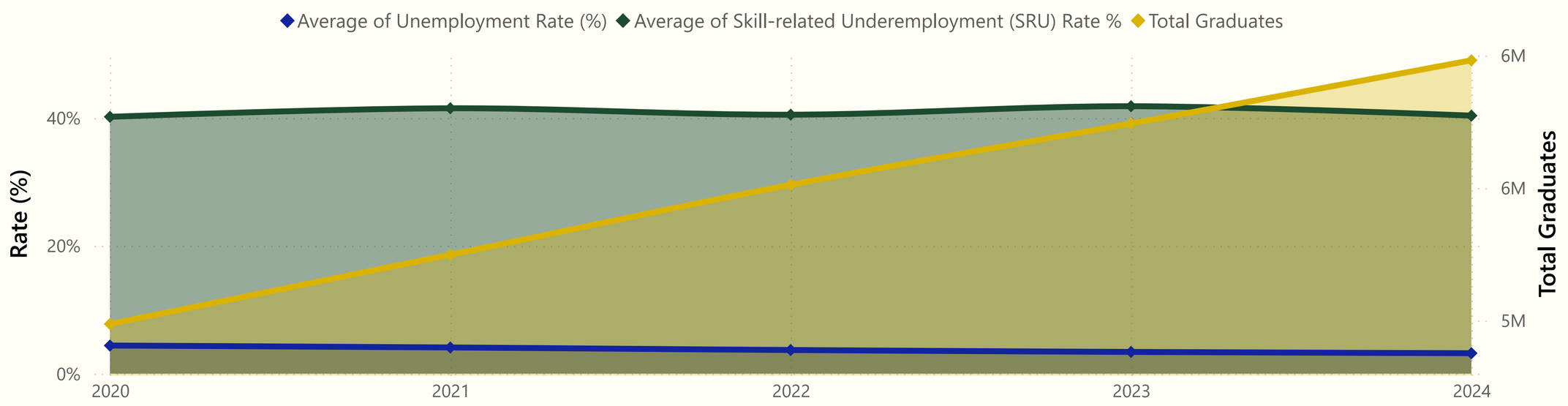
Year

2020

2024

Clear all slicers

Unemployed Graduates vs. Underemployed Graduates vs. Total Graduates



Key Finding

- The SRU rate reached a critical peak in 2023 (approximately 42%) before showing a marginal correction in 2024.
- The labor market is absorbing graduates into the wrong tiers of employment.
- Graduates are opting for "survival employment" to avoid the social and financial stigma of being jobless, creating a hidden layer of workers who are statistically employed but economically misaligned.

Career Uncertainty & Gen-Z Wellbeing

The Labor Mismatch (Unemployment & Underemployment)

Labor Market | Demographics

Overview

Labor Mismatch

Mental Health

Job Struggles

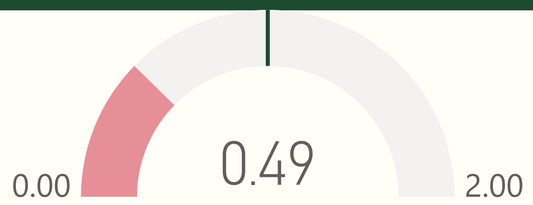
Year

2020

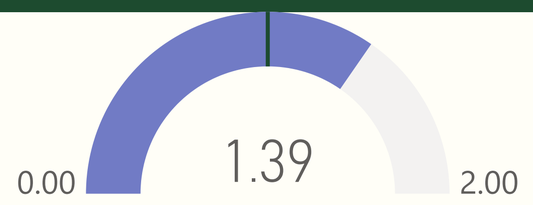
2024

Clear all slicers

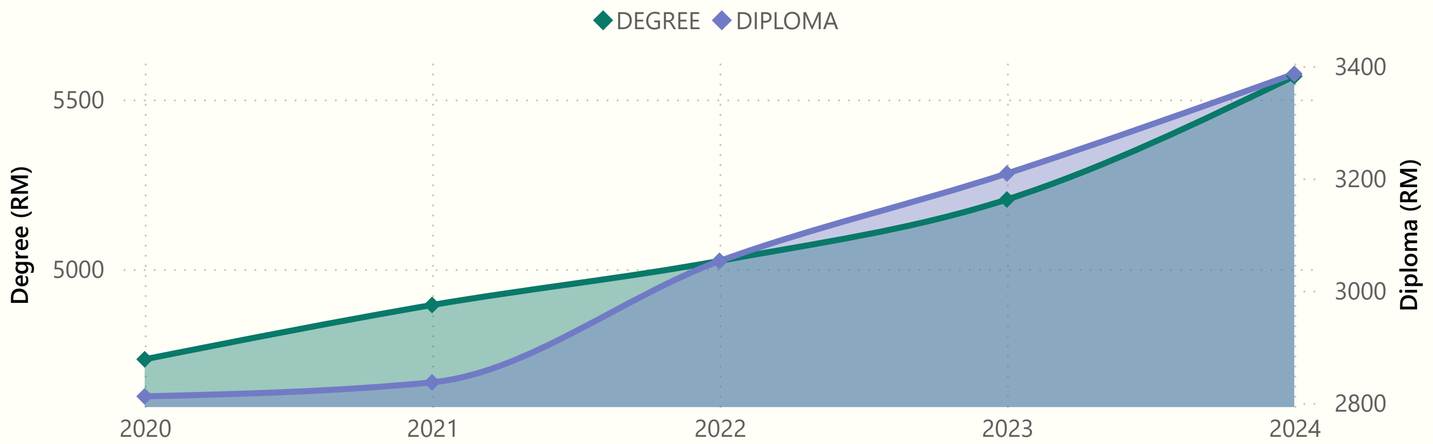
STEM GPI



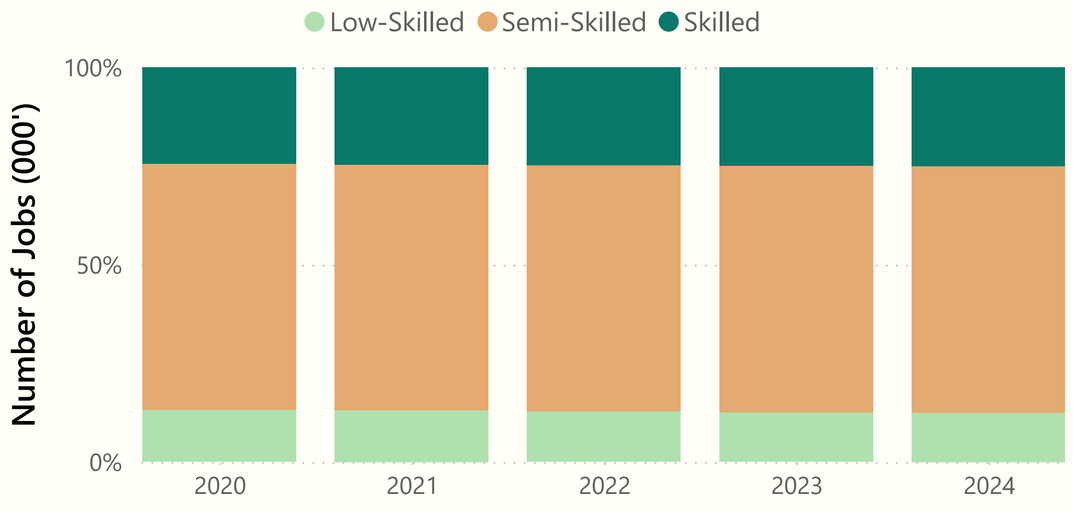
Non-STEM GPI



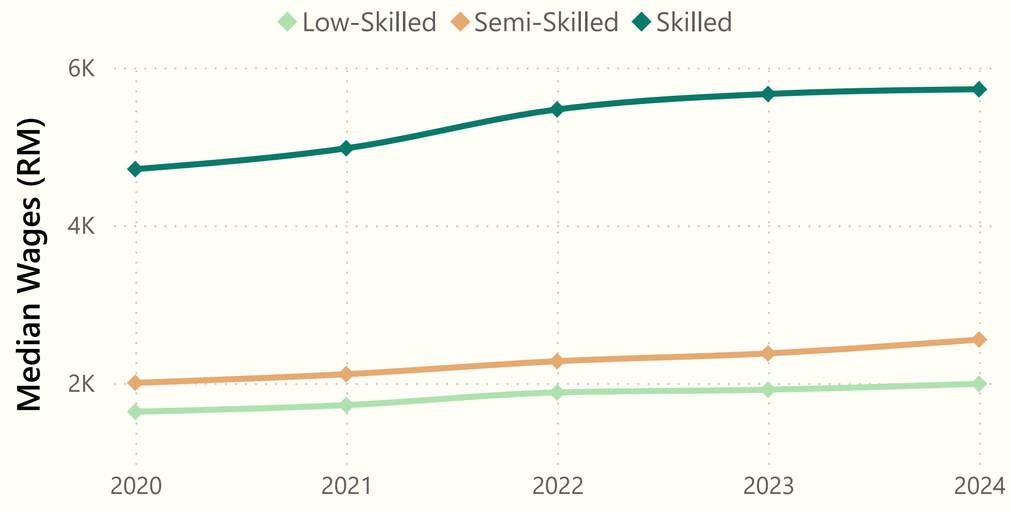
Median Salaries of Diploma vs. Degree



Labor Demand (000') vs. Skill Level



Median Salaries (RM) by year and Skill Level





Overview

Labor Mismatch

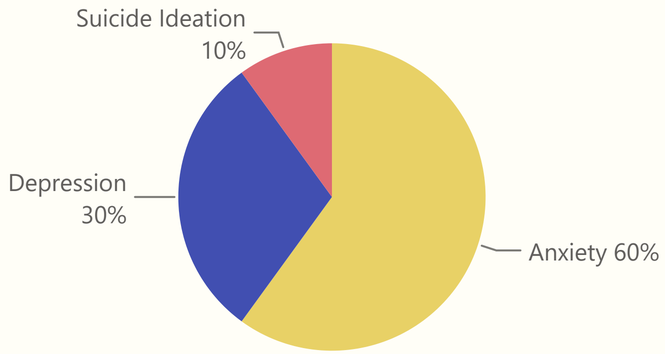
Mental Health

Job Struggles

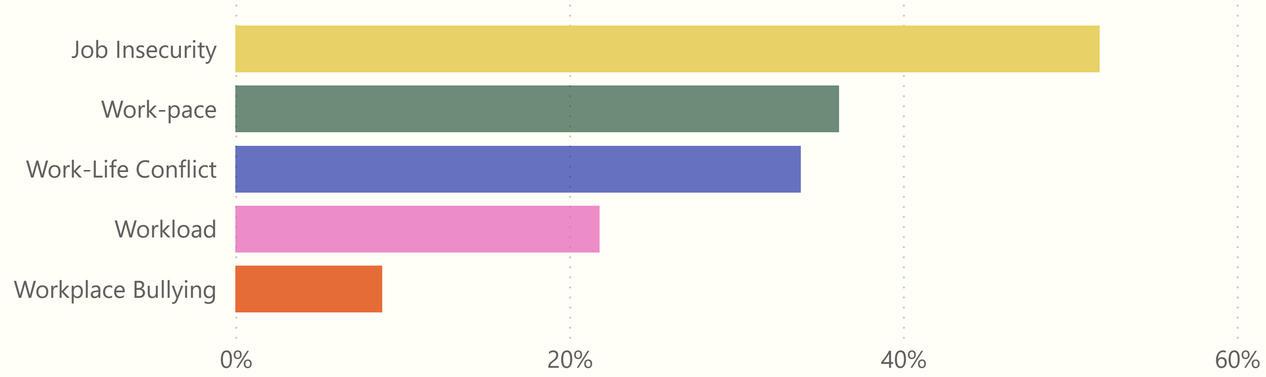
Career Uncertainty & Gen-Z Wellbeing

The Mental Health Landscape

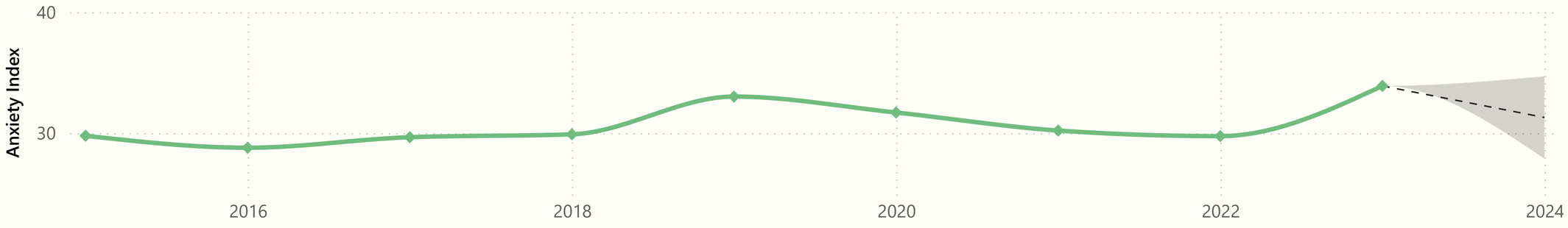
Mental Health Indicators (%)



Job insecurity & Stress Variance



Gen-Z Anxiety Index by Year



Job Insecurity (51.79%)

The leading cause of stress variance and future-anxiety.

Work-pace (36.16%)

High-intensity semi-skilled roles that offer little intellectual fulfillment.

Work-Life Conflict (33.88%)

Professional demands encroaching on personal recovery time.



Overview

Labor Mismatch

Mental Health

Job Struggles

Year

2020

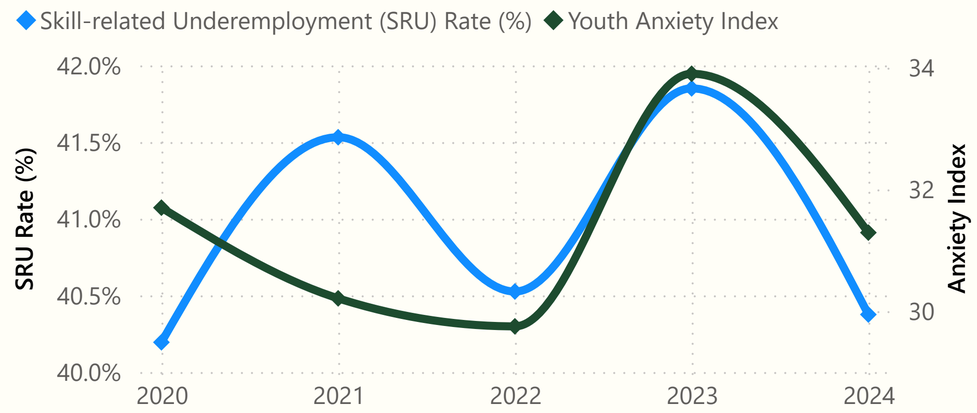
2024

Clear all slicers

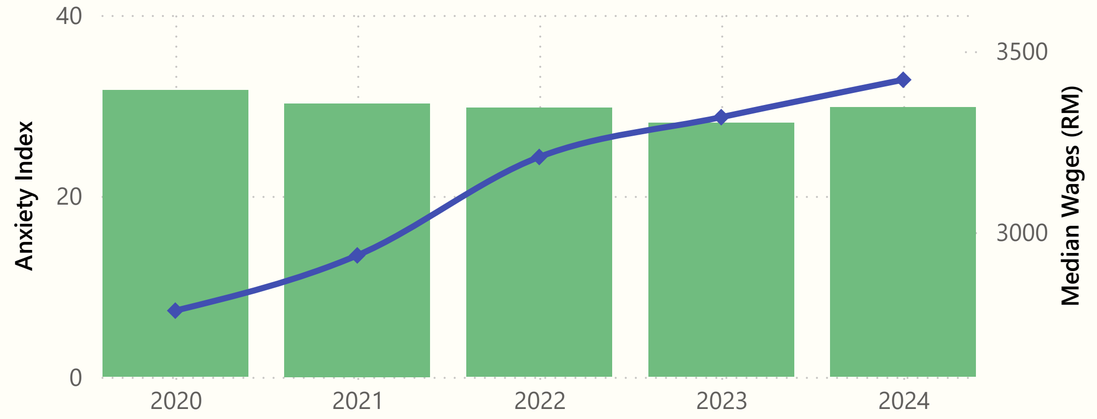
Career Uncertainty & Gen-Z Wellbeing

The Relationship Between Job Struggles & Mental Health

Anxiety Symptoms vs. Employment Precarity Timeline



Median Salaries vs. Anxiety Symptoms



Vulnerability Hotspots

Category	Segment	Details
Ethnicity	Others (Bajau, Iban, Bidayuh, Orang Asli etc)	Unemployment rate of almost half of the graduates population
Field of Study	Agriculture & Veterinary	The highest average of unemployment rate
Graduate Proliferation Index	STEM	GPI lower than 1.00
Level of Study	Diploma Holder	63.20% of unemployed graduates
Skill Level	Low-Skilled	Low demand and competitive salary

- The 2023 peak in Skill-Related Underemployment (SRU) coincided precisely with the 2023 peak in the Youth Anxiety Index (Score: 34).
- While rising median salaries provide a slight negative correlation with acute anxiety symptoms, they do not resolve the underlying vulnerability.
- The psychological distress caused by the "vertical mismatch" of being overqualified and under-utilized is not cured even with more money.